

SYSTEM SUITES

After having spent your money on buying the fastest PC that you can afford, it can be quite irritating to find that it doesn't perform up to your expectations for long. Given a little time, most systems begin to suffer from slower performance, frequent system crashes and problems due to viruses. This is where the System Suites come in and help you ensure that your system performs smoothly. They consist of several applications that work together to optimise the performance of all aspects of your system such as hard disk performance, the Windows registry and memory usage. It also helps protect against and diagnose the cause of application crashes.

As applications software continue to become more complex, getting great performance from your machine will continue to be a big challenge. While the type of applications that constitute the better system suites is not likely to change in the near future, the

arrival of newer operating systems such as Windows XP might make these seem less important for most users and the new architecture will almost certainly ensure the release of a version upgrade.



OnTrack System Suite 3.0



OnTrack is a good choice for registry cleaning. The boot up time increases by just 21 seconds, which is tolerable given the value one gets from it

OnTrack System Suite 3.0 heads the list as far as the features go. This suite has around 30 or more utilities which will take care of almost every task one can think of. The suite did not consume too much CPU power, which implies that you can take full advantage of this suite without slowing down the PC performance even if you don't have the latest processor fitted in your PC.

- + Low CPU utilisation
- + More than 30 utilities bundled

Price: Rs 3,000
Contact: OnTrack
Web site: www.ontrack.com
Reviewed in: February 2001

Worthy Mentions

Norton System Works

- + It takes just 14 minutes to defragment
 - + It uses very little RAM
- Price:** NA
Contact: Tech Pacific
Web site: www.symantec.com
Phone: 022-5960238
Fax: 022-5960102
E-mail: adil@techpacificindia.com
Reviewed in: February 2001

McAfee Office Central

- + Acceptable performance in registry cleaning
 - + Not very heavy on the CPU
- Price:** Not available
Contact: Network Associates
Phone: 022-6935278
Fax: 022-6147078
Web site: www.nai.com
Reviewed in: February 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: NA 1999: Norton System Works 2000
 1998: Norton Utilities Gold

VOICE RECOGNITION SOFTWARE

To many people, typing is a chore. The increasing power of desktop computers coupled with today's versions of voice recognition software makes it a snap when it comes to controlling nearly all the functions of your computer, whether it is writing and sending e-mail or launching applications. The core of these software has also seen a very definite improvement in terms of the speed at which voice recognition happens and in the time it takes to 'learn' a user's voice. Especially interesting is the fact that most of the software available today feature some form of adaptation to Indian dialects and accents, making it especially useful for applications in the Indian sub-continent.

The power of a speech recognition software rests in the underlying engine used to recognise voice and accurately decode phonetics of speech on the fly. The aim of manufacturers of speech recognition software is to create applications that drastically minimise the 'learning' time. We can look forward to applications that will practically require only minutes to recognise a new user's voice and this is going to spawn applications that will allow people to use speech as the form of data entry.



Dragon Naturally Speaking 5.0



An extremely effective voice recognition software which is appreciated for its high level of accuracy

This software won due to the simple fact that it was very accurate and very fast. It managed to be consistently accurate with all the technical jargon and, therefore, those of you interested in medical transcription can watch out for this software. Compared to other products in this category, it requires a comparatively less amount of processing power, which means that you can use this application alongside others and not have your system slow down to a crawl.

- + Extremely accurate and fast
- Price:** Rs 18,000
Contact: HCL Infosystems

Phone: 011-4526518
Fax: 011-4526579
Reviewed in: January 2001

Worthy Mentions

Philips Free Speech 2000

- + Provides a special Speech Mike
 - + Low CPU utilisation
- Price:** Rs 17,995
Contact: Philips India
Phone: 022-6912351
Fax: 022-6912499
E-mail: sameer.dania@philips.com
Reviewed in: January 2001

IMSI Voice Direct Continuous Gold

- + Low CPU utilisation
 - + Economically priced
- Price:** Not available
Contact: Microware Computer Services
Phone: 022-8729725
Fax: 022-8727446
E-mail: sales@mwcdrom.com
Reviewed in: January 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Dragon Naturally Speaking
 1999: Philips FreeSpeech 2000 1998: NA